

PHASE 1 – IDEATION PHASE

MODULE 1.3 – BRAINSTORMING

1.3.1 Introduction

Brainstorming is an ideation technique used to generate multiple possible solutions for an identified problem. In this project, brainstorming was conducted to identify different ways to improve the standard laptop procurement process.

The main goal was to find solutions that could reduce manual work, improve request processing, and provide better visibility to employees.

1.3.1 Brainstorming Objective

The objectives of brainstorming were:

- Identify possible automation opportunities.
- Reduce manual activities.
- Improve request processing speed.
- Automate approval-related activities.
- Improve task assignment.
- Provide better request tracking.
- Improve communication between employees and IT teams.

1.3.3 Ideas Generated

The following ideas were identified during brainstorming:

1. *Automated Laptop Request Submission*
Provide a structured form through ServiceNow for employees to submit standard laptop requests.
2. *Automated Approval Process*
Automatically send submitted requests to the appropriate approver.
3. *Flow Designer Automation*
Use ServiceNow Flow Designer to control the complete procurement workflow.
4. *Automatic Task Creation*
Create procurement or IT tasks automatically after approval.
5. *Automatic Task Assignment*
Assign tasks to the appropriate responsible team.
6. *Status Tracking*
Allow employees and responsible teams to track the current request status.

7. *Automated Notifications*
Send notifications when requests are submitted, approved, processed, or completed.
8. *Centralized Request Management*
Store and manage procurement requests in one ServiceNow environment.
9. *Automatic Status Updates*
Update the request status as the workflow moves through different stages.
10. *Request History and Tracking*
Maintain request information so that the progress of the order can be reviewed.

1.3.4 Idea Analysis

The generated ideas were analyzed based on their usefulness to the project.

Idea	Purpose
Request Form	Simplifies request submission
Automated Approval	Reduces manual approval handling
Flow Designer	Controls the workflow
Automatic Task Creation	Reduces repetitive work
Task Assignment	Sends work to the responsible team
Notifications	Keeps users informed
Status Tracking	Improves visibility
Centralized Records	Organizes request information

1.3.5 Selected Idea

The selected idea is:

“Automating Standard Laptop Orders using ServiceNow Flow Designer.”

This idea combines several of the generated concepts into one complete workflow.

The proposed automated process is:

Employee Request → Approval → Flow Processing → Task Creation → Task Assignment → Procurement → Fulfilment → Status Update → Notification

1.3.6 Reason for Selecting the Idea

The selected idea directly addresses the major problems identified during problem analysis and empathy mapping.

It focuses on:

- Reducing manual processing.
- Automating repetitive activities.
- Improving approval management.
- Assigning tasks systematically.
- Providing request status visibility.
- Improving communication through notifications.
- Managing the complete process in ServiceNow.

1.3.7 Expected Outcome

The brainstorming activity provides a clear direction for the project. The final solution is expected to create a structured workflow where the system performs predefined activities automatically instead of depending completely on manual processing.

The solution also provides a foundation for implementing the requirements in the next stages of the project.

1.3.8 Conclusion

Brainstorming helped generate and analyze different ideas for improving the IT procurement process. Several automation possibilities were identified, including automated approvals, task assignment, notifications, and status tracking.

Based on these ideas, the project selected *ServiceNow Flow Designer-based automation for standard laptop orders* as the proposed solution. This idea will be further developed during the requirement analysis and implementation phases.